WILLIAM TERRY, PhD

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Quantitative economist and public finance specialist with 20+ years of experience in budget development, financial forecasting, and data-driven decision support across government, academic, and non-profit settings. Deep expertise in cost center budgeting, multi-year financial modeling, ERP systems (SAP), and BI reporting (Tableau, Power BI). Track record of translating complex financial data into clear, actionable guidance for executive and legislative audiences. Actively incorporates AI-assisted tools into analytical workflows to accelerate data exploration, documentation, and research synthesis — with strong judgment about where human expertise remains essential. PhD in Political Science with a statistical methodology focus (UCSD); NSF Dissertation Award; postdoctoral fellowship at Princeton.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Budget Development & Variance Tracking · Multi-Year Financial Forecasting · Fund Accounting & ERP (SAP) · Rate & Fee Studies

Revenue Bond Compliance · Microsimulation Modeling · BI Reporting (Tableau, Power BI) · Stakeholder Communication

Statistical Analysis (R, Stata) · Excel · Bayesian & Frequentist Methods · Working knowledge of Python, SQL, Databricks

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The Two-Front War: Democratization and Its Consequences in the Post-VRA South 2026
Book Manuscript — Under Contract, University of Pennsylvania Press

- Completed full-time revision of contracted academic monograph for submission to Penn Press, September 2026. The book analyzes the fiscal and political consequences of the Voting Rights Act of 1965 in the American South using original datasets, Bayesian item response theory and multidimensional scaling, supervised and unsupervised machine learning, structural topic models, and panel regression methods.

Commissioner (Volunteer) — Tax Supervision & Conservation Commission, Portland, OR2025–2026

- Appointed by Governor Kotek to a four-year term on the constitutionally created body charged with reviewing and certifying that the annual budgets of Multnomah County's independent taxing governments — including the County, City of Portland, PPS, TriMet, and Metro — comply with Oregon State Budget Law.
- Provides an unparalleled working perspective on public-sector budget structures, fiscal constraints, and compliance requirements across the Portland metro area during a period of significant financial strain.

Senior Economist & Project Director — ECOnorthwest, Portland, OR 2025–2026

- Developed microsimulation model in R to forecast expected tax revenue for Multnomah County's Preschool for All (PFA) universal preschool program using Oregon Department of Revenue tax return microdata.
- Supported Oregon's Universal Health Governance Board Finance & Revenue Committee in constructing a comprehensive tax revenue plan to fund a statewide single-payer healthcare system covering all Oregonians including Medicaid and Medicare populations.
- Directed economic impact study quantifying Portland General Electric's contributions to the Oregon economy.

Financial Analyst III — Portland Bureau of Transportation, Portland, OR 2023–2025

- Managed annual budget cycle for 12 of PBOT's enterprise fund cost centers (~$45M operating budget), including consultative template design, line-item development with cost center managers, and post-submission variance tracking.
- Developed and maintained bureau-wide five- and ten-year financial forecasts covering ~$150M discretionary operating budget; built dynamic models updatable under changing financial and performance assumptions.

- Constructed complex rate and fee models; evaluated debt financing alternatives and funding strategies across PBOT's $500M operation; coordinated revenue bond issuance and monitored post-issuance compliance.
- Produced monthly budget-to-actual variance reports via SAP data exports, delivered as Tableau and Power BI dashboards to bureau leadership and cost center managers.
- Supervised a Financial Analyst III with responsibility for the City's multimillion-dollar Local Improvement District (LID) financing program; provided coaching, mentoring, and performance appraisals.

Research Manager — Prenatal-to-Three Policy Impact Center, Vanderbilt University, Nashville, TN 2020–2023

- Led construction of a state-level time-series cross-sectional dataset on child poverty and statutory policy parameters; oversaw in-house statistical research in R, Stata, and SQL.
- Developed fiscal impact statements and budget analyses for government clients; served as primary methodological resource for parametric and non-parametric program evaluation.

Assistant Professor, Political Science — University of Oregon, Eugene, OR 2010–2019

- Published peer-reviewed research in State Politics & Policy Quarterly, Legislative Studies Quarterly, Latin American Research Review, and Politics, Groups, and Identities, including time-series cross-sectional analyses of large-scale state and local budgetary data; research supported by NSF Dissertation Award.
- Taught PhD and undergraduate courses in statistics, research design, public budgeting, and Congress; supervised PhD students and served on faculty governance committees.

Postdoctoral Fellow — Department of Politics, Princeton University, Princeton, NJ 2009–2010

- Developed the research that became *The Two-Front War* and a time-series cross-sectional analysis of lynching rates in the American South.

Analyst, Tax Analysis Division — U.S. Congressional Budget Office, Washington, DC 1999–2001

- Served as primary analyst for the federal Earned Income Tax Credit (EITC), one of the nation's largest income supports for working families.
- Maintained and extended microsimulation code to produce EITC outlay estimates under current law and alternative policy scenarios using restricted-use IRS, Census, and SSA data.

CIVIC & VOLUNTEER ROLES

Director & Board Secretary — The Emerson School (K–5 PPS Charter), Portland, OR 2023–2025

- Member of the governing body legally responsible for the financial well-being of the school; direct involvement in budget formulation, variance oversight, and fiduciary compliance as a non-profit corporation.

Member, Budget Advisory Committee — Portland Police Bureau, Portland, OR 2023–2025

EDUCATION & FELLOWSHIPS

PhD, Political Science (Statistical Methodology focus) — University of California, San Diego 2010

NSF Doctoral Dissertation Award

MS, Mathematical Economics — California Institute of Technology 2004

BA, Economics & Mathematics — Washington University in St. Louis (*Magna cum laude*) 2002

Morgan Stanley Richard B. Fisher Scholarship